

shape of modern propellers in the 1903 when they performed their famous first powered flights. These were different than marine propellers as they included a twist along the length of the blades to ensure the angle of attack of the wind on the blades was kept relatively constant along their length. By the 1920s, the understanding of propellers was in fact complete and today, 100 years later modern propellers are only about 5% more efficient than they were almost a century ago.



For the geeks amongst us, you may be interested to note that any given propeller's size is described by two numbers with the first representing the diameter – critical when converting engine horsepower to thrust and the second representing the pitch, that is the distance the propeller moves with each complete revolution. Airplanes driven by propellers are ideal for applications where efficiency and cost outweigh speed requirements, which is the primary reason why airlines today continue to use these types of planes for short regional flights.

